

Lava Cap Historical Landmark

lavacapmine.com | Prepared for Misty Elder | September 29, 2026

Summary

Lava Cap Historical Landmark is a six page site (Home, History, Education, Visit, Donate, Contact) for a 501(c)(3) working to turn the Lava Cap Gold Mine into an educational site. It is built on the GoDaddy Airo builder. The design and structure are solid. What holds it back is missing contact details, information that contradicts itself, and a few claims that need checking before more people find the site.

6	0	2	6/6
pages reviewed	phone numbers	conflicting hours	pages have titles and descriptions

What is working

- **Clear mission and story.** Visitors understand what the place is within seconds, and the History page has a real timeline.
- **Good search basics.** Each page has its own title and description, a canonical address, a sitemap listing all six pages, and a robots file that allows Google in. Images have descriptive alt text and each page has one main heading.
- **Ways to give.** A PayPal donate button, donation levels, a volunteer path and a newsletter sign up are all present.
- **Compliance basics.** Privacy policy, terms of use and a cookie consent banner are in place. The Visit page covers accessibility and parking.
- **Social profiles linked.** Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, X and Twitch, all on the lavacapmine handles.

Priority fixes at a glance

#	Fix	Priority	Effort
1	Add a phone number, mailing or street address and a visible contact block in the footer	HIGH	15 min
2	Make hours, tour schedule and admission match on every page	HIGH	30 min
3	Verify or remove the unsourced quotes and the gold-per-ton figure	HIGH	30 min
4	Add a plain-language site safety and EPA cleanup status section	HIGH	1 to 2 hrs
5	Replace placeholder text on the Donate page	MED	20 min
6	Return a real “not found” response for bad addresses	MED	Builder setting
7	Add structured data, photos of the real site and a Google Business Profile	MED	1 to 2 hrs
8	Fix the “Lave Cap” typo and trim page weight	LOW	15 min

1. Trust and contact

No phone number, no street address **HIGH**

The only contact route is admin@lavacapmine.com and a generic “Nevada City, CA 95959.” The Visit page tells people to “call ahead,” but no number exists. Directions read “approximately 60 miles northeast of Sacramento,” with no address to type into a map. Visitors, teachers booking field trips and donors all need a person to reach. **Fix:** add a phone or voicemail line, a mapped address or meeting point, and put both in the footer of every page.

The calendar does not exist **HIGH**

Hours “may vary on holidays and during special events. Please check our calendar.” There is no calendar page or link. The addresses /calendar and /events show the same generic page. **Fix:** add a simple events list or remove the sentence.

Placeholder wording is still live **MED**

- Admission: “Pricing to be announced. Please check back closer to our opening.” This conflicts with “open to visitors” on the same page.
- Guided tour price: “Included with subscription.” There is no subscription anywhere on the site.
- Donation levels list “1 yr Free access to social media subscription” twice and “Authentic Payroll checkstub.” These read as drafts.

2. Accuracy and consistency

Item	What the site says	Action
Hours	Visit page: Thu–Fri 10–4, Sat–Sun 9–5, closed Mon–Wed. Contact page: Thu–Sun 9–5.	Pick the real hours and show them once, reused everywhere.
Tours	History page: “guided tours available year-round.” Visit page: guided tours on weekends and by appointment for groups of 10 or more.	Confirm current tour schedule and wording.
Quotes	“California Gold Rush Proverb” and a quote credited to the “Nevada County Historical Society.”	Add a real source or remove. Unsourced quotes hurt a history site.
Gold recovery	“300 ounces of gold per ton of ore processed.”	Looks like a typo. Public sources describe the mine’s total output in ounces; check the figure.
Facilities	“Welcome center,” “research facilities,” bus and shuttle options, “free on-site parking.”	Confirm each exists today. If planned, label it “coming soon.”
Workshops	Beekeeping and chainsaw/wood milling programs sit beside history programs.	Confirm they are active and add dates or a booking route.

3. Site safety and EPA cleanup status **HIGH**

Public records list the Lava Cap Mine as an EPA Superfund cleanup site for arsenic, placed on the National Priorities List in 1999 (see *USGS* and *EPA* pages on the Lava Cap Mine Superfund Site). The website invites visitors, school groups and children, and does not mention this anywhere. Search results for “Lava Cap Mine” will surface the EPA material either way. A short, plain-language section on current access rules, what areas are open and what the cleanup status is would build trust with parents, teachers and donors, and reduce the chance of surprises. We recommend the wording be reviewed by whoever advises the nonprofit on access and liability.

Note: we have not verified current EPA status or site access rules. This is a flag for you to confirm, not a conclusion.

4. Technical and search

Check	Result	Detail
Page titles and descriptions	PASS	Unique on all six pages, with sensible length.
Sitemap and robots	PASS	Sitemap lists all six pages and robots.txt allows crawling.
Canonical and social sharing tags	PASS	Canonical address and Open Graph tags are set. One shared og-image is used for every page.
Image alt text and headings	PASS	Descriptive alt text; one H1 per page.
Bad addresses	FIX	Made-up addresses such as /nonexistent-xyz load with a normal “200 OK” status instead of “404 not found.” Google may index empty pages.
Structured data	FIX	None found. Adding nonprofit and place markup helps Google show hours, address and donate details.
Page weight	WATCH	One 600 KB script loads on every page. Fine on wifi, slower on rural mobile service near Nevada City.
Typos	FIX	“Lave Cap Gold Mine District” appears on the History page.
Cookie banner and analytics	PASS	Consent banner present. We could not confirm which analytics tool is connected.

5. Google presence

This pass did not include Google Business Profile or map results. Searches for the Landmark returned mainly EPA, USGS and Wikipedia pages about the mine, which is a reason to claim and complete a Google Business Profile: hours, photos, link to the donate page and the safety information above. Recommended next step: confirm whether a profile exists and who owns it.

6. Website cost check

From the GoDaddy receipts: the Airo website plan is \$49.99 per month (\$599.88 a year), up from \$21.99 per month in 2025, on top of email, domain and protection. The site is six mostly static pages with a PayPal button. Before the October 9 renewal, it is worth pricing a lower cost plan or a simple hosted build, and confirming the payment method that GoDaddy flagged.

7. Suggested plan

When	What
This week	Confirm hours, tours, admission and facilities. Add phone, address and footer contact. Replace placeholder text and the typo. Fix or remove the unsourced quotes.
Next 2 weeks	Add the site safety section, an events list, structured data and real photos. Claim the Google Business Profile.
Before Oct 9	Decide whether to keep the current plan. Update the payment method on the account.

Privacy note: a login email in the inbox contains an account password in plain text. Please change that password and use a password manager or shared vault to send credentials in the future.